intersex
NIGERIA
CENTER FOR HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT & YOUTH EMPOWERMENT

INTERSEX NIGERIA

CENTER FOR HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT AND YOUTH EMPOWERMENT



DRIVING STRATEGIC IMPACT AND LONG-TERM SUSTAINABILITY

2025 ANNUAL REPORT

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info@intersexnigeria.org
www.intersexnigeria.org


INTRODUCTION
TO THE PROGRAM

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About us

Intersex Nigeria is an intersex-led and intersex focused non-profit organinsation founded in 2019 and officially registered in 2021. We are dedicated to advancing the rights, health and dignity of intersex persons in Nigeria and beyond. Guided by the principles of bodily autonomy, self-determination and social justice, we champion sexual and reproductive health, mental wellbeing, and human rights for intersex people through advocacy, research, empowerment and community-building initiatives.

Our work follows an intersectional approach from grassroots engagement to national, regional and global advocacy that drives inclusive frameworks and strengthens systems. We collaborate with intersex persons, families, caregivers, Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs), Civil Society Organisations (CSOs), Feminist groups, Faith based groups, and other stakeholders to strengthen awareness dignity and recognition.



Our Strategic Priorities

Movement Building and Partnership
We collaborate and network with other rights-based groups and networks to build a resilient intersex movement, enhancing the visibility of intersex persons over time.

Research and Advocacy
We conduct thorough research to understand the human rights issues affecting the communities we serve. We document human rights violations, collect data and gather testimonies from affected individuals to build evidence for advocacy campaigns.

Public Engagements
We organise events to improve the perception of the public on variations of sex characteristics and overcome structural barriers towards reducing all forms of stigma and discrimination and other human rights violations against intersex persons.

Capacity Strengthening and Building
We provide a comprehensive roadmap for systems strengthening aimed at organisational development,. By integrating best practices and emerging technology, we equip both intersex persons and our team with essential life competency skills.

Sexual and Reproductive Health & Rights Wellbeing
We develop and implement comprehensive sexuality education programmes that provide accurate information about sexual and reproductive health, including topics such as contraception, HIV and STI prevention, consent, gender equality and reproductive rights.

Our Vision

Our vision is to see a society where intersex persons, from birth, have rights to bodily integrity and autonomy and are free from stigma and discrimination.

Our Mission

Our mission is to create an enabling society that promotes the visibility, inclusion, bodily autonomy, sexual and reproductive health including mental well-being and human rights of intersex persons in Nigeria, through community organising, research, advocacy, and public engagements using a feminist lens.

Message from the Board Chair

It is with great pride and optimism that I reflect on another year of progress, resilience, and collective action at Intersex Nigeria. As an organisation committed to advancing the rights, dignity, and inclusion of intersex persons, we continue to witness both the challenges that persist and the remarkable strength of the community we serve.

Over the past year, Intersex Nigeria has continued to expand its impact through advocacy, community engagement, awareness creation, and strategic partnerships. These efforts reflect a shared commitment to challenging stigma, addressing harmful practices, and fostering a society where intersex persons can live with dignity, safety, and equal opportunities.

As Board Chair, I remain inspired by the dedication of our Executive Team, staff, volunteers, and community members whose passion continues to drive this important work forward. Their efforts remind us that meaningful change is possible when courage, compassion, and collaboration come together with purpose.

The Board remains steadfast in its responsibility to provide strategic guidance, strengthen accountability, and support the long-term sustainability of the organisation. We are committed to ensuring that Intersex Nigeria remains responsive to the needs of intersex persons while continuing to grow as a trusted voice for advocacy and inclusion.

We are equally grateful to our partners, donors, and allies whose support has enabled us to deepen our impact and expand opportunities for engagement and change. Your belief in this mission continues to strengthen our resolve and broaden what we can achieve together. While much work remains ahead, we move forward with renewed determination and hope.

We envision a future where intersex persons in Nigeria are fully recognised, protected, and empowered to thrive without discrimination or fear.

On behalf of the Board, I extend our sincere appreciation to everyone who continues to stand with us in this journey. Together, we are building a more inclusive and just society for all.



Sendi Danjuma Dafwat
Board Chair
Intersex Nigeria

Message from the Executive Director

As we reflect on the journey of the past year, I am filled with deep gratitude, hope, and renewed determination. The work of advancing the rights, dignity, and wellbeing of intersex persons in Nigeria continues to demand courage, collaboration, and persistence, and together, we have continued to move this vision forward.

This year has been one of learning, growth, and strengthened commitment. Across communities, healthcare spaces, and advocacy platforms, we have continued to challenge harmful practices, raise awareness, and create opportunities for dialogue around the realities of intersex persons in Nigeria. We have worked to strengthen partnerships, deepen community engagement, and ensure that intersex voices remain visible and heard in spaces where decisions are made.

At Intersex Nigeria, we understand that meaningful change takes time, but we also know that every conversation, every training, every partnership, and every act of advocacy contributes to building a society where intersex persons can live freely, safely, and with dignity. Our commitment remains rooted in creating an inclusive future where bodily autonomy, human rights, and access to affirming healthcare are respected for all.
None of this work would be possible without the resilience and courage of intersex persons who continue to share their experiences and advocate for change.

To our partners, donors, allies, and supporters, thank you for believing in this work and standing with us. Your trust and collaboration continue to strengthen our impact and expand what is possible.

To our dedicated team, thank you for your passion, hard work, and unwavering commitment to our mission. Your efforts continue to drive meaningful change and inspire hope within our community.

As we look ahead, we remain committed to strengthening advocacy, amplifying intersex voices, fostering strategic partnerships, and creating pathways for lasting change.

While challenges remain, we move forward with hope and determination, knowing that a more inclusive and equitable future is possible.

Together, we will continue building a Nigeria where intersex persons are seen, valued, protected, and empowered.



Obioma Chukwuike
Executive Director/ Founder
Intersex Nigeria


#RootedAndRising
#IntersexNigeria
Intersex Awareness Day
Celebrating Intersex Joy




Intersex Nigeria
BORN WHOLE
BORN RIGHT
BREAK THE SILENCE,
END THE VIOLENCE
ROOTED.
RESILIENT.
REAL.
INTERSEX
VOICES
MATTER


Intersex Awareness Day
#RootedAndRising
Celebrating Intersex Joy
JUST
DO
IT.

INTERSEX AWARENESS DAY 2025

Intersex Awareness Day 26th October, 2025 was more than a commemoration; it was a powerful gathering of community, solidarity, healing, and advocacy. Held over two days in Lagos, Nigeria, the event brought together intersex persons, civil society organisations, healthcare providers, stakeholders, media practitioners, development partners, and allies to celebrate visibility and strengthen the movement for intersex justice.

The commemoration began with a closed workshop on 25th October 2025, being facilitated by international intersex Activists. In a safe and affirming environment, rightholders engaged in conversations about body autonomy, human rights, self-advocacy, and the lived realities of intersex persons in Nigeria. The space encouraged honest dialogue, reflection, and learning, allowing participants to share experiences and deepen their understanding of their rights and identities.

The day also centered healing and emotional well-being. Through a therapist-guided support session rooted in healing justice principles, participants explored the intersections of identity, faith, disability, class, and gender while reflecting on their personal journeys. The conversations created opportunities for connection, mutual care, and collective healing, reminding participants.

The workshop concluded on a hopeful note with a creative paint-and-sip session where participants expressed their dreams and aspirations through art. The activity provided space for imagination and self-expression, encouraging participants to envision a future where intersex people can live freely, safely, and with dignity.



The following day, the energy shifted into celebration and public engagement as more than 130 participants gathered for the main Intersex Awareness Day event. The atmosphere was vibrant from the moment guests arrived, with red-carpet photographs, networking, and conversations setting the tone for a day dedicated to visibility and advocacy.

The event started with a keynote speech by the zonal coordinator of Lagos State (South-west zone) Dr Lucas Koyejo of National Human Rights Commission (NHRC). Throughout the event, speakers and panelists challenged harmful narratives that continue to shape public understanding of intersex people. Conversations focused on the impact of language, media representation, bodily autonomy, and the urgent need to end non-consensual medical interventions performed on intersex children and adults. Participants actively engaged in the discussions, sharing reflections and asking questions that underscored the importance of creating a society where intersex people are respected and protected.

Art and culture played a significant role in the day's activities. Dance performances, spoken word poetry, documentary screenings, and goodwill messages from partners created moments of reflection, celebration, and connection. Together, these creative expressions reinforced the message that intersex people deserve visibility, dignity, and the freedom to define their own lives.

The event also provided an opportunity to strengthen partnerships and deepen collaboration across sectors. Representatives from government institutions, civil society organisations, media platforms, and international partners reaffirmed their commitment to advancing intersex inclusion and human rights. These connections continue to play a vital role in building a stronger and more coordinated movement for change.

One of the most significant moments of the event was the launch of the **Intersex Human Rights Violations Report Vol. 1** and **Intersex Friendly Healthcare Toolkit.** These resources represent an important milestone in Intersex Nigeria's advocacy efforts. The violations report documents the lived realities and rights violations experienced by intersex persons, while the healthcare toolkit provides guidance for creating more respectful, informed, and affirming healthcare experiences. Together, these resources contribute to ongoing efforts to influence policy, strengthen accountability, and improve access to rights-based healthcare for intersex communities.





As the day drew to a close, participants gathered around the Intersex Commitment Tree, writing personal pledges and messages of solidarity. The tree quickly filled with commitments to advocacy, ally-ship, inclusion, and justice, serving as a powerful reminder that lasting change requires collective action.

While a few logistical challenges emerged, including vendor coordination issues and printing errors, the overall success of the event reflected the resilience, determination, and collective spirit of the intersex community and its allies.

Intersex Awareness Day 2025 ended with celebration, laughter, music, refreshments and dancing, but its impact extends far beyond those two days. The event strengthened community bonds, increased public awareness, amplified intersex voices, and provided new tools for advocacy and systems change. Most importantly, it reaffirmed a simple but powerful truth: intersex people belong, deserve to be heard, and must be at the centre of conversations that affect their lives.







Projects



Activities

Protecting Every Child

Intersecting Child Protection, FGM, and Intersex Realities in Abuja

True child protection requires an inclusive approach that leaves no child behind, bridging the gaps between distinct human rights movements to protect bodily autonomy. To build this unified front, Intersex Nigeria convened a landmark Two-Day residential dialogue on child protection, Female Genital Mutilation (FGM), and the Inclusion of Children with Differences in their Sex characteristics in Nigerian child protection frameworks in Abuja.

Held in February 2025, the workshop brought together key human rights advocates and child protection stakeholders to evaluate existing safety frameworks, challenge deep-seated societal misconceptions, and map out integrated advocacy pathways. The capacity-building sessions yielded an immediate, transformative impact on the participants' conceptual clarity, legal literacy, and strategic alignment.

Participants strengthened their understanding of core child protection principles, emphasizing that true protection must mandate children's meaningful participation in decisions affecting them and vigorously prevent any form of harm, abuse, or bodily exploitation.

A cornerstone of the discussion was establishing a cross-movement understanding of bodily integrity. The dialogue cultivated a powerful consensus regarding the structural and societal links between Female Genital Mutilation and Intersex Genital Mutilation experienced by intersex children.

Participants identified that both harmful practices are rooted in the same systemic issue: non-consensual medical interventions aimed at altering natural bodies to force them into rigid, binary societal norms. By recognizing FGM and infant intersex surgeries as dual violations of a child's fundamental right to bodily autonomy, the workshop laid the groundwork for stronger, collaborative cross-movement advocacy.



In addition to conceptual alignment, the dialogue served as a vital awakening regarding the domestic legal landscape. The sessions foster critical legal literacy by guiding stakeholders through an analysis of existing frameworks.

This exploration brought to light a stark and urgent policy gap: Nigeria currently lacks any explicit laws or rights frameworks designed to protect intersex children from non-consensual, cosmetic medical interventions during infancy. Recognising this complete absence of statutory safety nets galvanized the cohort, shifting the conversation from general awareness to targeted legislative urgency..

The ultimate benchmark of the dialogue's success is reflected in the concrete operational commitments made by the participants as they prepare to step down these learnings within their respective organisations. Empowered by the shared data and rights-based frameworks, the stakeholders outlined a clear blueprint to advance intersex inclusion across multiple sectors:

- Grassroots and Community Mobilisation: Launching strategic community engagements with traditional and religious leaders to dismantle cultural stigmas surrounding natural anatomical variations.



- Institutional Knowledge Transfer: Conducting step-down training sessions for internal organisational colleagues, volunteers, and frontline staff to integrate intersex-inclusive protocols into existing child rights frameworks.
- Strategic Policy and Digital Advocacy: Utilising social media for public sensitisation and spearheading policy advocacy aimed at securing future legislative protections for intersex minors.

By successfully intersecting the rights for child rights, gender justice, and intersex bodily integrity. This residential dialogue has set a new standard for holistic advocacy in Nigeria. The sustained momentum and collective action generated in Abuja ensured that the movement moves forward with a clear vision: a society where every child's innate dignity and bodily autonomy are fiercely and unconditionally protected.



Breaking Barriers

Intersex Education Takes Center Stage at Benue State NYSC Camp, Wannune

In May 2025, Intersex Nigeria extended its grassroots public engagements campaign to the National Youth Service Corps (NYSC) Orientation Camp in Benue State. Recognising corps members as vital agents of social change, the sensitisation program aimed to demystify intersex realities, dismantle deeply rooted cultural myths, and foster an environment of inclusion and respect within youth spaces.

NYSC orientation camps serve as a unique and vibrant melting pot, bringing together thousands of young, educated graduates from diverse cultural, religious, and geographic backgrounds across Nigeria. By engaging this dynamic demographic, Intersex Nigeria sought to spark critical conversations on human rights, bodily autonomy, and social inclusion at a formative stage in these young professionals' civic journeys.

The primary objective of the Benue State campaign was to demystify intersex realities and challenge deeply entrenched cultural myths. For the vast majority of the corps members, the sensitisation sessions provided their very first exposure to accurate, rights-based information regarding intersex and intersex traits.

The interactive sessions, led by Intersex Nigeria team, carefully unpacked the biological nuances of intersex variations. A key focus of the educational curriculum was clearly distinguishing intersex traits, which relate to innate variations in sex characteristics, from sexual orientation and gender identity.

By addressing common misconceptions head-on, the program provided a safe, respectful environment for open dialogue, allowing corps members to ask questions, unlearn harmful stereotypes, and gain a clear, evidence-based understanding of the intersex community.

Beyond foundational education, the sensitisation programme contextualised these realities within broader public health and human rights frameworks. We highlighted the unique and often invisible challenges faced by intersex individuals in Nigeria, ranging from non-consensual medical interventions in infancy to widespread medical stigma and a severe lack of inclusive healthcare infrastructure.



Corps members were introduced to core advocacy priorities, including the right to bodily integrity, access to sensitive mental health support, and the importance of gender justice. The sessions inspired the young graduates to view these challenges not as isolated issues, but as critical human rights concerns that require collective action and cross-movement allyship.

The true weight of the May 2025 sensitisation campaign lies in its long-term potential. These corps members are not just temporary participants; they are vital change agents poised to disperse into diverse sectors across Benue State for their year of primary assignment.

As these young allies deploy into local schools as teachers, rural hospitals as medical personnel, and administrative offices within local government areas, they carry this vital knowledge with them. By equipping a highly influential cohort with the language of inclusion and the tools to challenge stigma, Intersex Nigeria has effectively created grassroots network of advocates. This initiative stands as a powerful testament to the organisation's dedication to building an informed public, shifting national narratives, and fostering a society where the rights and dignity of all individuals are fiercely protected.







Stakeholder Engagement

Intersex Inclusion and Community Support

As part of its commitment to strengthening community understanding and promoting inclusive advocacy, Intersex Nigeria convened a stakeholder engagement session in Makurdi, Benue State, bringing together representatives from 15 civil society organizations in collaboration with Give Nigeria.

The engagement created an important platform for dialogue on intersex inclusion, human rights, and practical approaches to building safer and more supportive communities for intersex people. Participants explored the realities faced by intersex persons, addressed common misconceptions, and discussed the role of civil society organizations in advancing awareness, protection, and inclusion within their respective communities.

Discussions also highlighted existing policy and implementation gaps affecting intersex people and identified opportunities for stronger collaboration among civil society actors to promote inclusive programming and advocacy. Through interactive conversations and shared learning, participants strengthened their understanding of intersex issues and reflected on strategies for fostering environments where intersex people are treated with dignity, respect, and equality.

The engagement reinforced the importance of multi-sector partnerships in advancing intersex rights and demonstrated the value of equipping community stakeholders with accurate information and practical tools to challenge stigma and discrimination. By engaging organizations already working at the community level, the initiative contributed to building a broader network of allies committed to promoting inclusion and supporting the rights and wellbeing of intersex people across Benue State.

This activity forms part of Intersex Nigeria's ongoing efforts to expand community-based advocacy, strengthen partnerships with civil society organizations, and create sustainable pathways for protecting the human rights of intersex people throughout Nigeria.



Charting the Next Chapter

Intersex Nigeria Reflects on a Five-Year Journey of Impact

Intersex Nigeria conducted a Strategic Impact/Outcome Harvesting, designed to evaluate our organisational trajectory and programmatic outcomes from the year 2020 to 2025, to map the depth of our progress systematically. This retrospective allowed us to rigorously measure the cumulative impact generated across our initiatives and strengthen internal systems.

As part of the initiative, we partnered with an external technical consultant at Partons Global Initiatives to carry out the evaluation of this comprehensive review which was finalised in December 2025. Through collaborative data analysis and outcome-mapping sessions, we tracked how our advocacy has influenced policy, enhanced healthcare capacities, and strengthened human rights protection networks. These data-informed insights served as the foundation for creating powerful institutional evaluation tools to verify our long-term progress and optimise our operational structures.

Feedback from the impact harvesting process highlighted the immense value of rigorous multi-year documentation, the importance of aligning strategic investments with clear structural benchmarks, and the critical need to maintain data-driven accountability across all future programmatic outputs.

The evaluation process culminated in the development of critical strategic resources that document our half-decade footprint and safeguard our institutional memory. These included a comprehensive five-year impact evaluation report, localised outcome maps, a verified data summary of programme statistics, and an updated baseline indicator framework. These materials were designed for both internal and external use, making them highly adaptable for donor reporting, stakeholder engagement and policy advocacy.

The impact harvesting exercise created a powerful foundation for future planning, directly guiding the comprehensive review and co-creation of Intersex Nigeria's next multi-year strategic plan. The analytical sessions were deeply reflective, ensuring that our upcoming operational roadmap and future priorities such as inclusive national health frameworks and sustainable movement-building, are rooted in verified data and long-term community realities.



Core Data and Findings from the 2025 Review

To provide complete organisational accountability, the initiative captured the following data points, key findings, and strategic adjustments:

- **Movement Building & Partnerships:** Over 80% of our staff and board structure continue to be led by intersex persons to ensure authentic representation. Key achievements include high-level engagements with the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) and the Federal Ministry of Health (FMOH) to integrate intersex-sensitive care protocols into national guidelines , alongside regional cross-border advocacy through the VIRAL Project between Nigeria and Cameroon.

- **Research and Advocacy:** We successfully generated crucial empirical data, including the Beyond the Binary research project , a medical research report examining intersex birth practices in Nigerian hospitals , and the VIRAL Baseline Research Report mapping public perceptions of Intersex Genital Mutilation (IGM).

- **Public Engagement Successes:** Our advocacy footprint expanded into cultural spaces through the 700-capacity auditorium presentation of the stage play **"World Untold: Echoes of Silence"** in Abuja, mass media radio campaigns across Lagos via Star FM , and targeted grassroots leadership engagements in Lagos and Benue states.

- **Financial Performance:** The organisation demonstrated solid financial compliance and trust, with funding inflows peaking at ₦309 Million in 2024, maintaining a highly efficient 95% allocation toward direct programmatic activities.

- **Identified Gaps & Planned Actions:** The 2025 retrospective highlighted key areas for institutional strengthening. Priorities for the next strategic cycle include transitioning from transaction-focused operations to more sustainable institutional systems, strengthening governance and accountability, publishing annual independent audits, and implementing a formal Reserves Policy to improve financial resilience and preparedness for future funding challenges.



Shifting the Lens

Building Media Alliances for Intersex Visibility and Rights in Nigeria

Media narratives have the power to shape public perception, influence policy, and restore dignity to marginalised communities. Recognising this profound impact, Intersex Nigeria convened a pivotal High-Level Media Engagement Workshop in Lagos from April 2nd to 3rd, 2025. The strategic two-day session aimed to bridge the gap between media reporting and intersex realities, laying the foundation for accurate, sensitive, and rights-based coverage across the country.

Intersex Nigeria did not focus solely on frontline reporters only, rather, the workshop strategically targeted decision-makers; editors, producers, and senior media executives, who hold the power to shape newsroom policies and greenlight stories.
Nine influential media leaders participated, representing Nigeria's premier print, broadcast, and digital outlets, including:

- The Guardian
- The Nation Newspaper
- Premium Times
- HumAngle
- African Independent Television (AIT)
- Nigerian Television Authority (NTA)
- Federal Radio Corporation of Nigeria (FRCN)
- The Nigerian Union of Journalists (NUJ)

By engaging this elite tier of media professionals, Intersex Nigeria did not just deliver a training session; it cultivated a high-level network of influential allies dedicated to transforming the national discourse surrounding intersex individuals and their Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR).

The core objectives of the workshop were to challenge deeply entrenched, harmful stereotypes and equip participants with the tools necessary for dignified representation. The sessions were highly interactive, analyzing current narrative framing and unpacking the nuances of intersex realities within broader human rights and public health frameworks.

The collaboration yielded immediate, tangible institutional outputs:

- **Capacity Building:** Nine top-tier media executives were successfully upskilled in intersex-inclusive reporting, learning how to accurately frame stories around intersex experiences and SRHR.
- **Institutional Commitments:** Participating media houses pledged to actively integrate intersex perspectives into their upcoming programming, editorial line-ups, and publications.

- The Blueprint for Inclusive Journalism: Participants collaboratively developed a draft set of Media Toolkit Guidelines. This resource is specifically tailored to enhance intersex visibility and ensure adequate, respectful representation during media conversations on health and rights.

The workshop successfully shifted the relationship between the intersex advocacy movement and the mainstream media from transactional to deeply collaborative. By ensuring that the gatekeepers of public information are effectively and adequately informed, Intersex Nigeria has secured vital partnerships that will amplify the visibility of young intersex persons.

Ultimately, this initiative marks a definitive step forward in dismantling public stigma, correcting misrepresentation, and fostering a truly inclusive national media landscape.



Beyond Code

Financial Literacy and Leadership for Intersex Persons

Economic marginalisation and restricted access to professional growth are some of the most persistent barriers faced by intersex individuals in Nigeria. Recognising that financial autonomy is a fundamental pillar of human rights and self-advocacy, Intersex Nigeria launched a comprehensive ICT Skills Empowerment Initiative. Designed as a holistic, multi-phase workforce entry programme, this targeted initiative supported five intersex individuals across Abuja and Lagos, equipping them with the tools, knowledge, and experience necessary to thrive in the modern digital economy.

Sustainable empowerment begins with a strong structural foundation. Before diving into digital skills vocation, the initiative concluded with an intensive two-day financial management and leadership training. This phase was strategically designed to equip participants with essential economic life skills, covering budgeting, personal financial planning, resource allocation, and basic bookkeeping. By prioritising financial literacy. Intersex Nigeria ensured that participants were not only prepared to acquire technical skills but were also structurally equipped to manage, invest, and grow the revenue those skills would eventually generate.

A defining feature of this initiative was its person-centered approach: rather than enforcing a rigid, one-size-fits-all curriculum, participants were encouraged to choose and specialize in the specific tech pathways that aligned with their personal interests and career aspirations.





To ensure the transition from classroom learning to the professional market was seamless, the training was immediately followed by a three-month hands-on internship. This critical practical phase allowed the participants to master their selected skills within real-world professional environments.

Beyond refining their technical capabilities, the internship programme focused heavily on the entrepreneurial aspects of the tech industry. Participants learned how to pitch to clients, package their expertise, navigate freelance platforms, and successfully convert their digital skills into sustainable income streams and viable business models.

The ultimate benchmark of the initiative's success lies in the remarkable professional breakthroughs achieved by the participants by the conclusion of the programme. The impact of this nine-month journey has translated into tangible socioeconomic advancement.

Thriving Self-Employment: Several participants successfully launched their own freelance practices and independent micro-enterprises, operating as self-employed digital professionals who command their own income.

Corporate and Career Advancement: Other participants utilized their newly certified technical skillsets and internship portfolios to secure significant career advancements and promotions within their existing places of employment.

By investing deeply in these five individuals, Intersex Nigeria has created a powerful blueprint for economic empowerment, one we hope to build on and increase. This initiative proves that when young intersex persons are provided with specialised training, proper institutional support, and real-world economic pathways, they can break through systemic barriers, redefine their trajectories, and become self-reliant leaders in the digital age.



Unerased and Whole

Institutionalizing Inclusive Intersex Healthcare with the Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare (FMoHSW)

April 14–17, 2025: As part of an activity implemented under the "UNERASED AND WHOLE" project, Intersex Nigeria (Center for Healthcare Development and Youth Empowerment) conducted an intensive four-day sensitisation workshop in Abuja for 30 staff members of the Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare (FMoHSW).

The workshop achieved deep cross-departmental representation, bringing together technical officers and stakeholders from Family Health Department; the Gender, Adolescent, School Health and Elderly (GASHE) division; Nutrition; Traditional, Complementary and Alternative Medicine Department; Child Health Department; Reproductive Health; Public Health Department; Hospital Services; Health Promotions Department; and the Department of Health Planning, Research and Statistics.

This capacity-building activity focused on addressing systemic knowledge gaps and mapping out institutional reforms across several core areas:

- **Values Clarification & Attitude Transformation:** Participants engaged in interactive exercises to confront implicit and explicit biases, examining how unconscious personal values directly shape healthcare delivery and contribute to the social exclusion of intersex individuals.
- **Clinical Clarity (Intersex 101):** Facilitators demystified intersex variations by separating biological sex characteristics from socially constructed gender concepts , explaining common genetic and anatomical variations , and challenging harmful medical misconceptions, such as the false belief that cosmetic infant surgeries are a clinical necessity.
- **Vulnerabilities and Statutory Gaps:** The training highlighted severe hardships faced by the intersex community in Nigeria, including non-consensual procedures, medical discrimination, and resulting psychosocial trauma like depression and anxiety. Comprehensive legal reviews exposed critical policy voids, noting that existing frameworks; including the 1999 Nigerian Constitution as amended, the Child Rights Act, and the Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act (VAPP) Act, lack explicit protections to safeguard the bodily autonomy of intersex minors.



The activity concluded with direct operational commitments from participating ministry divisions to institutionalise inclusive healthcare practices across the national health system:

- **Policy Integration:** The GASHE division committed to establishing pathways to integrate intersex inclusion into national healthcare interventions and recommended formally including Intersex Nigeria in departmental Technical Working Groups (TWGs).
- **National Guidelines & Clinical Oversight:** Partners outlined steps to develop a national Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) to protect the rights of intersex patients in medical facilities. Additionally, the Specialty Hospital Division planned targeted sensitisations for committees of Chief Medical Directors (CMDs) to secure institutional leadership buy-in.
- **Public Awareness & Mental Health:** Representatives from the Health Promotion and Planning divisions recommended integrating comprehensive intersex-specific information into the upcoming national Social and Behavioural Change Communication (SBCC) strategy review. Concurrently, the Mental Health Division pledged to incorporate intersex-specific psychosocial care into national mental health initiatives.
- **Curriculum Reform:** The workshop's final action plan prioritised integrating evidence-based intersex education directly into medical school curricula and Continuous Medical Education (CME) training protocols for frontline healthcare workers.



Future-Proofing Operations

Internal Capacity Building and the Transition to a Hybrid Structure

Intersex Nigeria in a deliberate move to fortify its operational resilience and amplify its public impact, Intersex Nigeria organised two vital capacity-building training sessions tailored specifically for its staff and management. Recognising that robust internal structures are the bedrock of sustainable human rights advocacy, these dual interventions focused on equipping the team with advanced skills in strategic communication and safeguarding organisational assets.

The first component of the training focused on Strategic Communication and Advocacy, providing staff with advanced narrative framing techniques and evidence-based message development to counter public stigma and engage health stakeholders. Concurrently, the organisation conducted a comprehensive training on Digital and General Security, upskilling staff and management on proactive risk mitigation, data protection, and robust digital hygiene protocols.

The true success of these training sessions lies in their immediate, structural application. Rather than leaving the insights in the classroom, Intersex Nigeria utilized the momentum to overhaul its operational framework, adapting to modern workplace dynamics while heavily prioritising data safety.

Following the training, the organisation successfully transitioned to a flexible hybrid work model, balancing remote productivity with essential in-person collaboration. To support this new structure securely, Intersex Nigeria institutionalised a closed-model workspace for organisational communication using Zoho Workspace.

By migrating to this centralised, secure digital ecosystem, the organisation has created a fortified perimeter for its internal dialogues, file sharing, and project management. This closed-model approach ensures that sensitive information, rights-based advocacy data, and internal strategy documents are strictly safeguarded against external vulnerabilities.

By strategically connecting voice, safety, and infrastructure, Intersex Nigeria has ensured that its team is not only equipped to advocate boldly on the front lines but is also structurally insulated to collaborate safely, efficiently, and sustainably in a digital-first environment.



Engage, Encourage and Empower (EEE) Programme

Building Resilience and Leadership Among Young Diverse SOGIESC Population

In 2025, Intersex Nigeria expanded the Engage, Encourage and Empower (EEE) Programme to Abuja and Lagos, providing 30 young SOGIESC population with opportunities to develop life skills, strengthen their mental wellbeing, and build leadership capacity.

The programme combined life competency training, psychosocial support, and mentorship to equip participants with practical skills in self-awareness, communication, decision-making, emotional intelligence, reproductive health, online safety, and leadership. Through structured learning sessions, psychotherapy, and peer support activities, participants were provided with safe and affirming spaces to learn, heal, and connect.

The programme contributed to increased self-confidence, self-acceptance, and resilience among participants while improving their ability to navigate social, educational, and professional challenges. It is also expected to strengthen participants' mental wellbeing, enhance peer support networks, and reduce feelings of isolation often experienced by intersex and gender diverse youth.

Beyond personal development, the EEE programme nurtures a new generation of community leaders and advocates. By investing in young people's knowledge, skills, and wellbeing, the programme is laying the foundation for stronger community engagement, increased advocacy participation, and greater visibility of intersex voices in Nigeria.

The expansion of the EEE programme from 20 to 30 participants in both States, reflects Intersex Nigeria's commitment to empowering young SOGIEC persons with the tools, confidence, and support systems needed to thrive and become agents of positive change within their communities.





Breaking the Silence

How the VIRAL Project is Redefining Intersex Advocacy in West and Central Africa

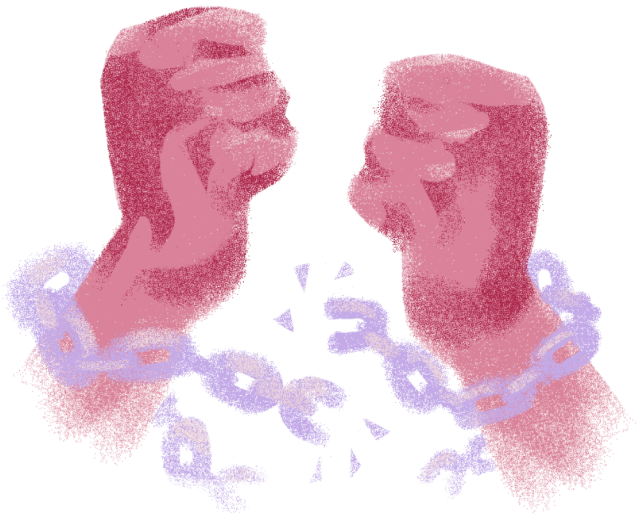
For decades, human rights and healthcare frameworks across West and Central Africa have largely operated within a rigid gender binary, leaving intersex individuals structurally invisible. This systematic neglect has not only fueled widespread societal stigma but has also permitted human rights violations, such as Intersex Genital Mutilation (IGM), to persist under the radar of public accountability.

To confront these deep-rooted social norms, Intersex Nigeria launched a groundbreaking, two-year regional initiative: **The Visibility, Inclusion and Recognition of Intersex Persons in Nigeria and Cameroon (VIRAL) Project.** Designed to bridge massive empirical gaps, the project set out to evaluate public perception, dismantle harmful myths, map localised legal and healthcare barriers, and promote fundamental human rights. This project implemented in Nigeria and Cameroon and concluded in 2024, was evaluated for impact in 2025.

This evaluation was done by utilising comprehensive public surveys alongside deeply personal qualitative interviews with intersex individuals, families, and medical practitioners who were part of the VIRAL project, the resulting VIRAL Project Evaluation Report offers a definitive look at the current state of intersex advocacy, its measurable progress, and the steep road ahead.

The VIRAL baseline assessment revealed a stark contrast in public awareness between the two target countries, illustrating that regional knowledge remains non-uniform and highly dependent on local advocacy saturation.

In Nigeria, public education efforts yielded highly encouraging data: 86% of respondents demonstrated a solid understanding of what intersex variations are, and an impressive 95% of participants possessed accurate knowledge regarding the realities of IGM. Conversely, the data from Cameroon highlighted a critical need for foundational public education. Only 47% of Cameroonian respondents showed a good understanding of intersex realities, while 50% maintained only a fair understanding.



These figures prove that while targeted advocacy can successfully shift public knowledge, misconceptions still cloud the societal lens in regions where advocacy resources have historically been constrained. Despite these regional disparities, stakeholders and community members overwhelmingly recognised the VIRAL project as a vital mechanism for social change.

When measuring the project's capacity to build community recognition, 82% of respondents in Nigeria rated the initiative as "very effective." In Cameroon, where the terrain proved more challenging, 50% of respondents gave the project the same high rating. Furthermore, the initiative proved its worth as a policy-shifting tool: 86% of institutional stakeholders in Nigeria and 69% in Cameroon affirmed that the VIRAL project had generated a profound, measurable impact on advancing rights-based advocacy across civil society and government spaces.

One of the most critical battlegrounds for intersex advocacy is the clinical environment. For generations, infant intersex bodies have been subjected to irreversible, non-consensual "corrective" surgeries. Shifting the medical paradigm from purely cosmetic pathology to human rights-based, dignified care is a primary goal of the VIRAL project.

Following targeted clinical training interventions, the technical report noted a substantial leap in healthcare provider capacity:

- 68% of trained healthcare professionals in Nigeria reported feeling well-equipped to manage, counsel, and respond to intersex health needs with dignity.
- 67% of trained healthcare workers in Cameroon expressed the same high level of preparedness.

The report's findings on public visibility are a sobering reminder of the psychological toll of stigma.

This near-identical progress across both borders provides a powerful, scalable model for future interventions, proving that clinical mindsets can be successfully reprogrammed toward intersex-sensitive care protocols when given proper data-driven training.
While institutional and medical progress is undeniable, the personal safety and comfort of rights-holders remain heavily constrained by societal hostility.

In Nigeria, 60% of intersex individuals surveyed reported feeling only "somewhat comfortable" speaking openly about their rights in public spaces, while 20% felt completely uncomfortable doing so out of fear for their safety and social standing. In Cameroon, the environment was even more fragmented, with comfort levels evenly split at 33.33% across three categories: very comfortable, somewhat comfortable, and entirely uncomfortable.

These metrics highlight a crucial reality: public awareness does not automatically equate to community safety. Genuine inclusion will only be achieved when intersex persons can step into the public eye without fearing systemic discrimination or physical harm.

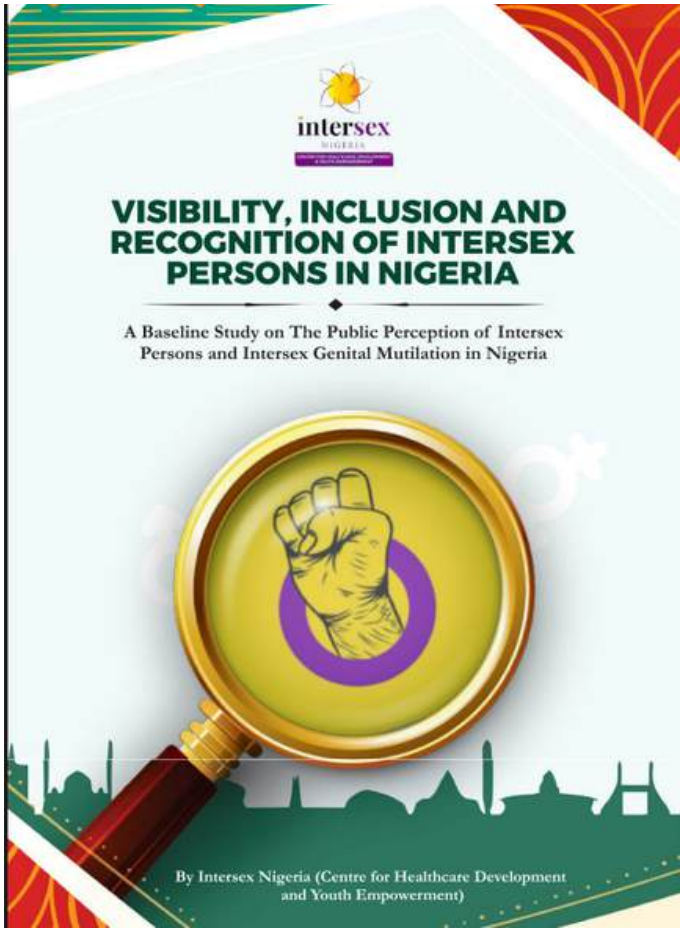
The implementation of a multi-country, multi-lingual project is rarely seamless. The VIRAL project navigated significant operational headwinds, including mid-cycle staffing transitions in Nigeria and severe budgetary strains caused by regional inflation. In Cameroon, the team had to manage complex language barriers and abrupt activity cancellations due to localised security and socio-political dynamics.

However, these challenges provided invaluable institutional lessons. Rather than pulling back, Intersex Nigeria is using these findings to build a more robust, sophisticated roadmap for the upcoming strategic cycle.

Moving forward, the organisation is pivoting from periodic, event-based campaigns to continuous, institutionalised stakeholder engagement. Recognizing that systemic change requires targeting the root nodes of community influence, future initiatives will focus on:

- Cultivating institutional partnerships with national bodies like the Ministry of Health to formalise inclusive healthcare protocols.
- Deploying targeted, intentional outreach to religious leaders, parents of intersex children, and family planning organisations—the exact cohorts identified as pivotal to dismantling grassroots stigma.

The VIRAL Project Evaluation Report stands as a masterclass in data-driven accountability. By laying bare both its massive triumphs and its operational vulnerabilities, Intersex Nigeria has provided the global human rights community with a clear blueprint for how to move from mere visibility to total systemic transformation.



Inclusive Cycle

Redefining Menstrual Health for Intersex Visibility

Executed entirely across Intersex Nigeria's mainstream social media channels, the digital advocacy campaign set out to systematically dismantle these barriers. Over the course of four months, the initiative provided evidence-based, inclusive education that validated intersex bodies, explained the diverse biological nuances of intersex menstruation, and challenged the deeply entrenched cultural stigmas surrounding reproductive anatomy.

By utilizing dynamic infographics, interactive Q&A sessions, video explainers, and real-life storytelling, the campaign transformed complex public health concepts into accessible, engaging digital content. The strategy successfully ignited a vibrant online dialogue, capturing the attention of a massive and diverse audience.

By the conclusion of the four-month run, the campaign achieved remarkable viral momentum: the educational content directly reached over 28,000 people globally and domestically. The campaign sparked meaningful interactions from healthcare professionals, human rights advocates, feminist organisations, and the general public, prompting thousands to unlearn binary stereotypes. Crucially, the digital comment sections and anonymous forums provided a rare, affirming community space for intersex individuals to openly share their personal experiences with menstruation and medical healthcare delivery without fear of judgment.

Intersex Nigeria's digital campaign has done more than just raise awareness; it has established a new benchmark for inclusive sexual and reproductive health education. By bringing an invisible conversation to the forefront of the digital space, the organisation has laid the groundwork for a more empathetic, medically accurate understanding of menstrual health.

This short-term digital wave represents a long-term structural push toward an inclusive world, one where medical frameworks, public health campaigns, and societal narratives fiercely acknowledge, validate, and support the health and dignity of every individual, regardless of their sex characteristics.



Solidarity and Sanctuary

Safe Space Workshop on Intersex Menstrual Health, Wellness, Rights, and Resilience

In a society where biological variations are frequently pathologised and cloaked in medical secrecy, finding a space where one's body is celebrated rather than studied is a rare, life-altering experience.

The "Affirming Bodies, Claiming Health" workshop represents a landmark intervention under the Sang Pour Sang (SPS) Project. Designed as a response to systemic invisibility and the medicalised stigma surrounding intersex variations in Nigeria, the workshop successfully bridged the gap between clinical knowledge and lived experience. Over two days, Intersex Nigeria convened 15 intersex individuals and their families to address the intersections of menstrual health, bodily autonomy, and mental well-being, which took place from November 19 to 20, 2025 in Abuja.

The training was in two sessions: Understanding Menstrual Health and Medical Ethics, and Mental Health and Resilience Building which was facilitated by a medical practitioner and a mental health professional

The clinical journey began by dismantling the rigid gender binaries that dominate Nigerian healthcare and education and challenged the pathologising medical model through a biological diversity lens. The education extended deeply into gender-inclusive menstrual literacy..

Crucially, the first day closed with a fierce rejection of surgical violence, utilising frameworks from the World Health Organisation and the UN Committee Against Torture to empower families to defer non-consensual, cosmetic infant surgeries until the individual can provide informed consent.

The second day shifted focus from physical anatomy to the internal landscape of trauma and psychological resilience. The mental health professional opened the floor by clarifying that intersex-related trauma does not originate from the intersex body itself, but rather from a hostile social environment filled with medical secrecy and identity invalidation

Participants shared the deeply personal ways this systemic hostility manifests in their daily lives. the participants unpacked how chronic stress locks the nervous system into a state of hyper-vigilance, severely disrupting natural sleep architecture

The workshop did not just focus on theory but also active somatic healing. The participants were equipped with an actionable "Resilience Toolkit" designed to intercept panic and anchor the mind during moments of distress. Together, the families practiced the 5-4-3-2-1 sensory check-in, emotional regulation techniques like "Name It to Tame It," positive anchoring statements, and somatic deep breathing cycles to intentionally down-regulate nervous systems traumatized by past medical discrimination.

Driven by this collective resolve, the group formulated three structural recommendations for systemic reform:

- **Hospital Liaison Officers:** Establishing trained intersex advocates on institutional advisory boards for surgeries to guide vulnerable parents.
- **Birth Registration Reform:** Amending legal documentation to recognize "Intersex" at birth, thereby removing the immediate, coercive legal pressure for binary gender-assignment surgeries.
- **Sustained Service Delivery:** Expanding funding lines to guarantee ongoing clinical support, hormonal care, and specialist training for healthcare workers.

The immediate statistical data from the workshop's monitoring and evaluation underscored the power of this intervention. By moving beyond rigid clinical study and stepping into radical celebration, the Safe Space workshop successfully transformed fifteen isolated families into an unshakable nucleus for bodily integrity in Abuja.







Cultivating the Next Generation of Movement Leaders From Intensive Training to Strategic Mentorship

Intersex Nigeria implemented a multi-phased capacity building initiative designed to fortify the grassroots architecture of the intersex rights movement in Nigeria. By bridging intensive theoretical education with continuous, real-world application, this initiative established a sustainable pipeline of resilient, highly capable advocates equipped to drive institutional change.

From June 11th to 13th, 2025, Intersex Nigeria convened a three-day residential Leadership and Advocacy Training in Abuja. The programme brought together nine passionate intersex rightsholders from diverse geopolitical zones across Nigeria, establishing a unified and informed advocacy front.

This engagement was guided by a collaborative facilitation team, with a comprehensive curriculum cut across three core pillars:

- Identity & Human Rights.
- Strategic Advocacy in Action.
- Transformative Leadership Lenses.

To translate this intensive training directly into grassroots action, Intersex Nigeria launched a three-month mentorship programme which ran from September to November 2025. Five selected intersex advocates from the training cohort were paired with intersex Activists both within and outside Nigeria.

This multi-month intervention provided the emerging advocates with critical, individualized guidance, acting as a strategic sounding board for localized campaign planning and community engagements. By linking local rights-holders with veteran international activists, the programme facilitated essential cross-border learning, expanded professional networks, and grounded foundational knowledge into practical, sustainable advocacy toolkits.

Crucially, the combination of residential peer connection and sustained mentorship successfully shattered the profound isolation often experienced by intersex advocates in Nigeria. By investing heavily in enhanced conceptual clarity, practical planning toolkits, and continuous expert support, Intersex Nigeria has successfully cultivated an unshakable core of new leaders prepared to navigate complex socio-legal terrains and advocate unapologetically for bodily autonomy.

EXTERNAL ENGAGEMENTS



Intersex Nigeria at the Commission on the Status of Women (CSW)

The Commission on the Status of Women (CSW) is the United Nations' largest annual gathering dedicated to advancing gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls. Convened at the UN Headquarters in New York, it brings together governments, civil society organisations, activists, and development partners from across the world to assess progress, share experiences, and shape global standards on gender justice.

Participation in CSW as Intersex Nigeria represents a critical opportunity to amplify the voices, realities, and rights of intersex persons within global feminist and human rights spaces. While CSW discussions traditionally focus on women and girls, there is a growing recognition of the need for inclusive approaches that address the experiences of people with diverse sex characteristics, including intersex individuals who often face systemic discrimination, medical human rights violations, and social exclusion.

By representing Intersex Nigeria at CSW, the organisation contributes to bridging this gap by:

- **Advocating for inclusive policies:** Engaging in dialogues that push for the recognition of intersex persons within gender equality frameworks, particularly in areas of bodily autonomy, access to justice, and healthcare rights.

Sharing lived realities and evidence: Presenting research, community experiences, and programmatic insights from Nigeria to highlight the unique challenges faced by intersex persons in African contexts.

Building strategic partnerships: Connecting with global feminist movements, UN agencies, and civil society actors to strengthen collaboration and solidarity for intersex inclusion.

Influencing global outcomes: Contributing to conversations that inform CSW agreed conclusions and recommendations, ensuring that intersex perspectives are not left behind in global commitments on gender equality.

The 69th session of CSW (CSW69), held in March 10th to 21st 2026, focused on strengthening access to justice and eliminating discriminatory laws and practices affecting women and girls. This theme strongly aligns with Intersex Nigeria's advocacy priorities, particularly in addressing harmful medical practices, legal invisibility, and structural barriers to justice experienced by intersex persons.



Overall, representing Intersex Nigeria at CSW is both a strategic advocacy platform and a movement-building opportunity. It ensures that intersex voices are visible in global gender discourse and contributes to shaping a more inclusive, rights-based approach to gender equality that leaves no one behind.















Pan Africa ILGA 7th Regional Conference Johannesburg, South Africa

Intersex Nigeria participated in the Pan Africa ILGA Conference, a continental gathering of activists, civil society organisations, and human rights movements committed to advancing equality, justice, decolonisation, and collective liberation across Africa. The conference provided a valuable platform for networking, knowledge exchange, and strengthening regional collaboration on issues affecting LGBTQI+ communities, including intersex persons.

As part of the conference, Intersex Nigeria engaged in both the LBQGNC Pre-Conference and the Intersex Pre-Conference, where discussions focused on movement-building, wellbeing, legal advocacy, and strengthening solidarity across communities. Conversations highlighted the importance of care-centred activism rooted in Black feminist principles and Ubuntu, while exploring practical approaches to community wellbeing, inclusive leadership, and collaboration across diverse social justice movements.

The Intersex Pre-Conference provided an opportunity to assess progress and challenges facing intersex organising across Anglophone, Francophone, and Lusophone Africa. Discussions emphasised the importance of recognising intersex as a variation in sex characteristics (VSC), addressing persistent legal and resource gaps, improving visibility, and strengthening continental advocacy.

Intersex Nigeria also shared its experience organising within Nigeria's restrictive legal environment, highlighting how existing legislation indirectly affects intersex persons and the strategies used to sustain advocacy and community engagement despite these challenges.

The conference revealed growing interest among African organisations in learning from Nigeria's intersex movement, particularly its approaches to organising, advocacy, and resilience within complex legal and social contexts. Participants also exchanged perspectives on opportunities for stronger regional collaboration, cross-learning between sub-regions, and collective action to improve awareness, legal recognition, and protection of the rights of intersex persons across the continent.



Beyond the intersex-focused sessions, the conference reinforced the importance of embedding care, inclusion, and solidarity into movement-building efforts. Discussions also explored the role of faith, cultural narratives, and community engagement in promoting acceptance and countering discrimination, providing valuable insights that will inform future advocacy and public education initiatives.

Participation in the conference significantly strengthened Intersex Nigeria's visibility within the Pan-African human rights movement and expanded opportunities for strategic partnerships and collaboration. New connections established during the conference, alongside increased interest in the organisation's work, created pathways for future knowledge exchange, joint advocacy, and regional initiatives that advance the rights, representation, and meaningful participation of intersex persons across Africa.
The conference reaffirmed the value of continental solidarity in addressing shared challenges and demonstrated that collaborative, community-led approaches remain essential to building a more inclusive and equitable future for intersex persons throughout Africa.



A Seat at the Regional Table

Intersex Nigeria Joins the AIM/UNDP Consultation on Resolution 552 and 55

From April 29 to May 1, 2025, Intersex Nigeria joined intersex activists in Africa, UN agencies, and regional partners in South Africa to shape a shared strategy for advancing intersex rights across Africa.



For four days in South Africa, a room filled with intersex activists from across the continent did something that rarely happens: it planned together. The African Intersex Movement (AIM), in partnership with the United Nations Development Programme's **WeBelongAfrica** programme, convened a regional consultation meeting bringing together Intersex activist and leaders, UN agencies, and regional human rights leaders to chart a common path forward on intersex advocacy, health and human rights. Intersex Nigeria was represented by Obioma Chukwuike, AIM's Board Chair and our Executive Director, and by Hyellaiti David Haniel.

Intersex persons across Africa continue to face non-consensual medical interventions, exclusion from legal recognition, discrimination in education and employment, and, in the most severe cases, infanticide and abandonment. Yet the policy landscape is shifting. The UN Human Rights Council's Resolution 55/14 and the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights' Resolution 552 have, for the first time, given the movement concrete instruments to press governments for change. The question the consultation set out to answer was how to turn those resolutions into action on the ground.

The consultation meeting is followed by Representatives from UNDP, OHCHR, UNAIDS, UNICEF, WHO, and UNFPA joined with AIM's delegations. The meetings also focused on: how should intersex organisations engage the machinery of UN human rights mechanisms, treaty bodies, and special procedures, and how should those institutions, in turn, structure their support to reach intersex organisations like ours?



A standout moment was the presentation of a new joint policy brief by UNDP and AIM, Advancing the Health & Human Rights of Intersex Persons in Africa: Policy Guidance, designed to help intersex activist, law and policy makers and civil society organisations translate Resolution 55/14 and Resolution 552 into domestic law and practice. UNDP Policy Specialist Tapiwa Mamhare walked participants through how the guidance is developed and its components.

The consultation closed not with a communiqué but with commitments: from UN Agencies and bodies present on supporting and advancing the rights of Intersex persons in their positions and spaces.

As Nigeria's intersex rights landscape continues to develop, our participation in this consultation reaffirmed something we already knew from our own work and experiences at home: change happens fastest when it is built in community, not isolation. The relationships strengthened in South Africa with AIM, with UNDP, and with fellow intersex activists and leaders from across the African continent will continue to shape and strengthen Intersex Nigeria's advocacy.

By centering the voices of intersex persons, UNDP and its partners are helping to lay the groundwork for a future where intersex persons in Africa can live free from stigma, with dignity, rights, and access to the services they need.





TIERs "Our African Family, Culture & Values" Conference

Intersex Nigeria participated in the inaugural Our African Family, Culture & Values Conference, organised by The Initiative for Equal Rights (TIERs), bringing together activists, scholars, policymakers, faith leaders, and civil society organisations to explore the relationship between African cultural values, family systems, and human rights.

The conference provided an important platform to examine how culture can be harnessed to promote inclusion, dignity, and equality across diverse communities centered on the theme "Reclaiming African Family, Culture and Values," the conference challenged dominant narratives that portray human rights as incompatible with African traditions.

Through keynote presentations and panel discussions, participants explored how indigenous African values rooted in community, empathy, solidarity, and mutual respect can serve as a foundation for advancing inclusion and protecting the rights of all people, including intersex persons and other historically marginalised communities.

A key focus of the conference was the growing influence of religious fundamentalism and anti-rights movements across the continent. Speakers examined how these narratives have contributed to discrimination, exclusion, and violence, while highlighting the important role that progressive faith leaders, cultural custodians, and civil society organisations can play in promoting more inclusive and compassionate interpretations of African values.

Discussions reinforced the need for evidence-based advocacy, public education, and strategic partnerships to counter misinformation and strengthen respect for human dignity.



Interactive dialogue sessions encouraged participants to reflect on the influence of storytelling, language, public policy, and cultural expression in shaping social attitudes and advancing social change. A cultural exhibition featuring African art, music, and storytelling further demonstrated the power of creative expression as a tool for advocacy, public engagement, and community dialogue.

Participation in the conference strengthened Intersex Nigeria's understanding of culturally grounded advocacy approaches and reinforced the importance of ensuring that intersex voices remain visible within conversations about African identity, family, and culture. The engagement also created valuable opportunities to build relationships with regional partners and exchange ideas on promoting inclusive narratives that reflect Africa's diverse realities.

The conference reaffirmed that authentic African values are grounded in compassion, community, and respect for human dignity. The insights and partnerships gained will continue to inform Intersex Nigeria's advocacy, community engagement, and efforts to advance the rights and inclusion of intersex persons through culturally relevant and rights-based approaches.





Africa Pride 2025 at Kigali, Rwanda

Intersex Nigeria participated in the Pride Africa 2025 Conference in Kigali, Rwanda, representing the organisation alongside activists and human rights defenders from 31 African countries. The conference provided an important platform to strengthen regional solidarity, exchange knowledge, and explore collaborative approaches to advancing the rights of LGBTQI+ communities across Africa.

The conference opened with a keynote address focused on resilience, solidarity, and the future of LGBTQI+ advocacy in Africa. Discussions underscored the importance of decolonising advocacy approaches, responding to the growing influence of anti-gender movements, and ensuring that leadership and advocacy efforts remain inclusive of communities that are often marginalised, including intersex persons, persons with disabilities, and young people.

Throughout the conference, participants engaged in discussions on movement sustainability, strategic partnerships, and policy engagement. Sessions explored practical strategies for strengthening organisational systems, diversifying funding sources, promoting ethical fundraising, documenting impact, and building long-term institutional resilience. Conversations also highlighted the value of cross-sector partnerships and coordinated advocacy in advancing human rights across the continent.

Interactive workshops further equipped participants with practical skills in grant writing, fundraising, movement building, and organisational wellness. These sessions emphasised language justice, inclusive leadership, conflict transformation, accountability, and transparency as essential elements for building stronger and more sustainable social justice movements.

Intersex Nigeria's participation reinforced its commitment to strengthening regional collaboration, enhancing organisational capacity, and applying shared learning to improve advocacy, institutional development, and movement-building efforts. The conference also created valuable opportunities to establish new partnerships and deepen existing networks that will support future advocacy for the rights, dignity, and inclusion of intersex persons in Nigeria and across Africa.



Field impact Stories

During the menstrual health workshop with intersex persons and their families, an inspiring story emerged from the experience of an 18-year-old intersex participant.

Before attending the engagement, the young person faced discrimination and exclusion at school from both peers and teachers. These experiences affected his confidence and sense of belonging, leaving him unsure of himself and his identity.

During the workshop, key discussions focused on self-worth, self-acceptance, and understanding one's body and identity as an intersex person. According to his father, the engagement brought a remarkable change in his son's confidence and outlook.

After the workshop, he returned to school with a stronger sense of self. Rather than remaining silent when faced with discrimination, he found his voice. He became confident enough to challenge harmful comments, correct misconceptions, and stand up for himself when others attempted to stigmatise him.

His elder sister also shared a touching testimony. She explained that for many years, although they were siblings, conversations about his identity and personal experiences were difficult and often avoided. However, after the engagement, her brother took the initiative to discuss himself openly, his body, and his experiences.

(*Name withheld for privacy)

PROGRAM IMPACT

Throughout the year, our engagements created meaningful opportunities for dialogue, knowledge sharing, and reflection, contributing to increased awareness and understanding of intersex realities.

2025 By the Numbers



2,328

Direct capacity-building engagements, including workshops, dialogues, and intensive trainings, enabled meaningful engagement with and support for high-level stakeholders and policymakers.



28,312

those who engaged with our programs through awareness events, surveys and consultations.

Movement Building



Partnerships

African Women's Development and Communication Network (FEMNET)

Intersex Nigeria officially joined FEMNET to strengthen collaboration within the African feminist movement and ensure that intersex issues are meaningfully represented in regional conversations on gender equality, bodily autonomy, human rights, and social justice. The partnership provides opportunities for knowledge exchange, collective advocacy, movement building, and increased visibility of intersex rights within broader feminist spaces.

Our partnership with FEMNET reflects our commitment to building stronger alliances across the African feminist movement. Through this collaboration, Intersex Nigeria continues to amplify intersex voices in regional advocacy spaces, contribute to collective action on gender justice and human rights, and foster learning and solidarity with feminist organizations working toward inclusive and equitable societies.



Induction into the Child Protection Network

Intersex Nigeria's induction into the Child Protection Network, FCT chapter was aimed at strengthening child protection efforts by ensuring that intersex children are recognised and included within existing safeguarding and child welfare systems. The partnership creates opportunities for referrals, collaboration, awareness raising, and advocacy to improve access to protection and support services for intersex children and their families.

Joining the Child Protection Network marked an important step in strengthening collaboration with child-focused institutions and stakeholders. The engagement seeks to promote greater awareness of the rights and protection needs of intersex children, encourage inclusive safeguarding practices, and enhance referral pathways that support the safety, dignity, and wellbeing of intersex children and their families.







CHALLENGES

Limited Access to Sustainable Funding
Securing flexible, unrestricted, and long-term financial support remains a significant challenge for the organisation. While project-based grants have enabled the implementation of key activities, they often come with limited flexibility and fixed timelines, making it difficult to respond to emerging community needs or invest in long-term institutional growth. This funding landscape affects the organisation's ability to sustain ongoing programmes, expand successful interventions to new communities, strengthen organisational systems, and undertake strategic planning with greater certainty.

Barriers to Community Reach
Nigeria's rich linguistic and cultural diversity continues to present challenges in ensuring that advocacy messages and educational resources are accessible to all communities. Language differences, particularly in rural and underserved areas, can limit awareness, participation, and meaningful engagement with intersex issues. These barriers underscore the importance of developing multilingual communication materials, strengthening community-based partnerships, and adopting locally relevant approaches that make information more inclusive, culturally appropriate, and easier to understand.

Safety and Security Concerns
The sensitive nature of intersex and human rights advocacy continues to expose staff, partners, and community members to a range of safety and security risks. These include online harassment, misinformation, and targeted attacks, as well as potential security concerns during community outreach, public events, and advocacy engagements. Addressing these risks requires continuous investment in security protocols, digital safety practices, risk assessments, and safeguarding measures that protect everyone involved while ensuring advocacy efforts can continue effectively and responsibly.

LESSONS LEARNED

The Importance of Sustainable Resources
Our experiences throughout the year reinforced the importance of securing long-term, flexible, and sustainable funding to strengthen organisational resilience. Reliable resources enable the organisation to plan strategically, respond to emerging needs, invest in institutional development, and ensure the continuity and long-term impact of programmes beyond project cycles.

Inclusive Communication Improves Reach
Engagement with diverse communities highlighted the value of tailoring communication to local contexts. Using multiple languages, culturally relevant messaging, and accessible formats helps break down barriers to information, encourages meaningful participation, and ensures that advocacy efforts reach a broader and more diverse audience.

Creative Storytelling Drives Engagement
Our communication efforts showed that audiences respond more positively to visual, human-centered, and story-driven content than to text-heavy materials. This reinforced the importance of investing in illustrations, videos, digital storytelling, and other creative communication approaches that make complex issues easier to understand while fostering stronger connections with diverse audiences.

Safety & Security Must Remain a Priority
The year reaffirmed that effective advocacy requires a strong commitment to safety and security. Proactive risk assessment, digital security practices, safeguarding measures, and ongoing security awareness are essential to protecting staff, partners, and community members while ensuring advocacy activities can be carried out confidently and responsibly in both online and offline environments.

LOOKING AHEAD

Expanding Program Reach and Partnerships
We will continue to expand the reach of our programs by building stronger partnerships and engaging new stakeholders to deepen our impact and advance support for intersex persons across communities.

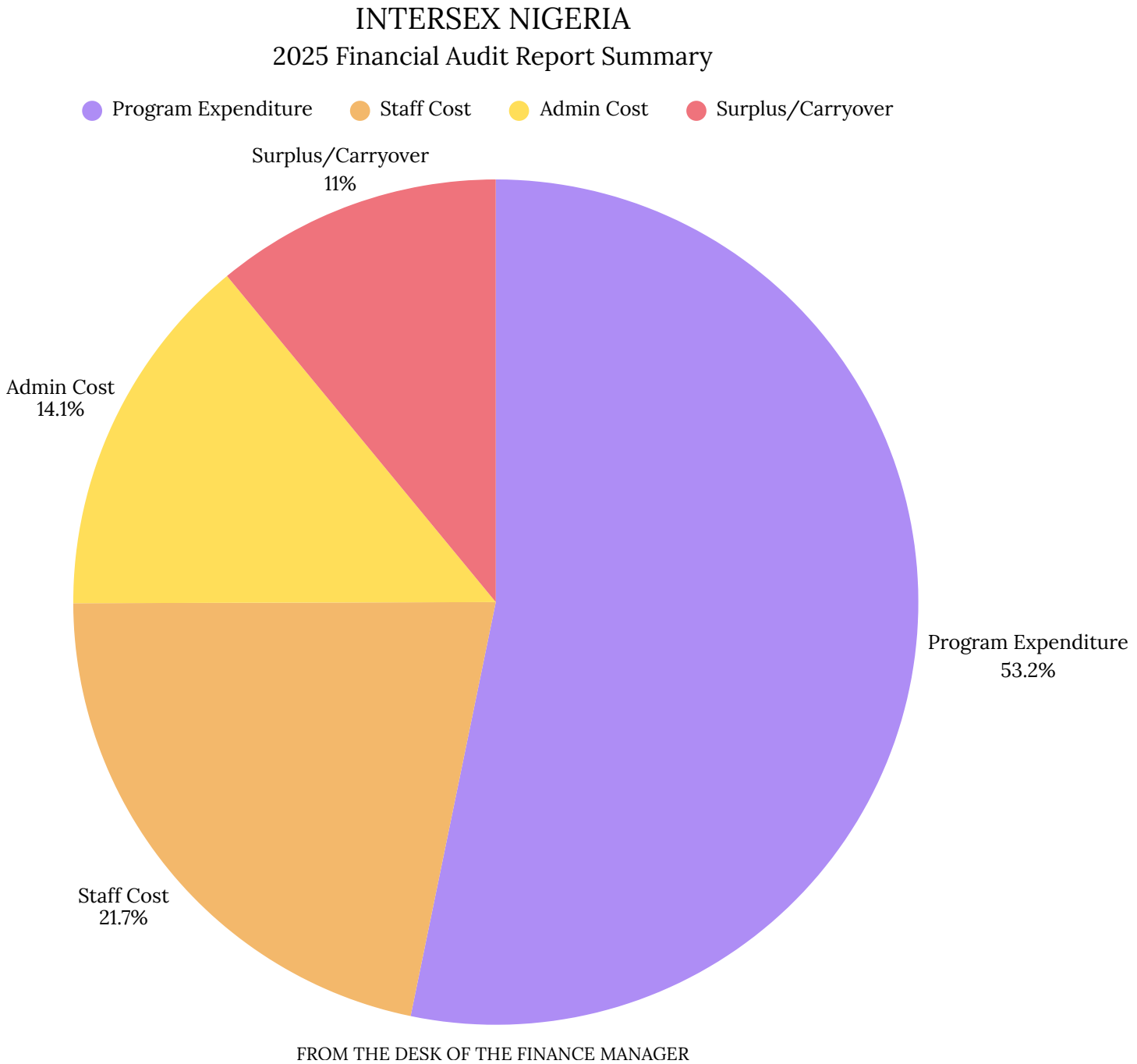
Strengthening Advocacy Efforts
We remain committed to advancing advocacy at both national and international levels to promote the rights, visibility, and inclusion of intersex persons while influencing policies and systems that uphold dignity and justice.

Empowering Intersex Communities
We will continue to create safe spaces for learning, engagement, and connection by strengthening community-led initiatives, increasing access to information, and supporting the leadership of intersex persons, families, caregi ers and allies.

Enhancing Communication and Visibility
We aim to strengthen how we tell our stories by embracing more visual, creative, and people-centered communication approaches, while ensuring our resources remain accessible, inclusive, and available in multiple languages.

2025 Financial Audit Report Summary (Report of the Auditors)

2025 Financial Summary	Amount (₦)	Percentage
Total Income	294,578,600	100%
Program Expenditure	156,806,588	53%
Staff Costs	64,000,733	23%
Admin Costs	41,445,000	14%
Surplus/Carryover for the Year	32,326,359	10%



FROM THE DESK OF THE FINANCE MANAGER

APPRECIATION

As we reflect on our work in 2025, we extend our deepest gratitude to the donors, partners, allies, and community members who stood with us in advancing the rights, dignity, and visibility of intersex persons in Nigeria. Your support made it possible for us to strengthen advocacy, deepen This community engagement, expand awareness, and respond to the realities faced by intersex people with care and courage.

We are honoured to recognise the invaluable support of the following partners and funders, listed in no particular order. To Mama Cash, African Women's Development Fund (AWDF), EMpower, Outright International, Hivos, Astraea Foundation, the Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare, FOS Feminista (The Agence Française de Développement (AFD), and COC Netherlands for believing in this work and investing in a future where intersex persons are respected, protected, and included.

Your trust, solidarity, funding, and continued partnership gave us the strength to amplify voices too often unheard, challenge harmful norms, and create safer spaces for intersex persons and their families. Thank you for walking this journey with us and for helping us move closer to a society where every intersex person can live with dignity, autonomy, and equal rights.

Intersex Nigeria

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